



STATISTICS SIERRA LEONE

FOREIGN TRADE STATISTICS BULLETIN - 2013

Foreign Trade Statistics Section
Economic Statistics Division
Statistics Sierra Leone

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Foreword

Foreign trade statistics provide information on the goods trade between Sierra Leone and the other countries in the world. Foreign trade statistics are the only official source of information regarding Sierra Leone's import, export and trade balance. This Bulletin is part of the effort of Statistics Sierra Leone (SSL) to provide credible macro-economic indicators of the Sierra Leone's economy. The objective of this publication is to provide an in-depth foreign trade performance analysis and also to make available a range of foreign trade statistics to a wide range of users including policy-makers, business executives, researchers and the general public so as to guide policies bordering external trade transactions. The publication has relied mainly on data obtained from Customs statistical declarations submitted by traders, using the ASYCUDA++ file system of trade, which must be provided for all import and export consignments. Also data is obtained from other institutions especially Government Gold and Diamond office (GGDO), National Revenue Authority (NRA), Ministry of Fisheries and Marine Resources, Commodity Monitoring and Marketing Unit (CMMU), Sierra Leone Ports Authority, National Mineral Agency (NMA) and Bank of Sierra Leone (BSL) for major domestic exports such as agricultural and mineral exports. At Statistics Sierra Leone, the data obtained from Customs is processed and compiled using the EUROTRACE (windows-based) Software. The data presented in this bulletin provides a wide range of statistics at various levels of disaggregation of trade flow such as direction of trade by country of destination and origin, imports by Standard International Trade Classification (SITC) and the harmonized system (HS) of classifying foreign trade transactions between Sierra Leone and the rest of the world.

Within the framework of the National Strategy for the Development of Statistics (NSDS) in Sierra Leone, Statistics Sierra Leone (SSL) is in close collaboration with the National Revenue Authority (NRA), Sierra Leone Investment and Export Promotion Agency (SLIEPA), Bank of Sierra Leone (BSL) and the Ministry of Trade Industries (MTI) so as to harmonize foreign trade data compilation and processing in the country. The publication of this bulletin is an effort towards fostering this close collaboration as well as to provide a channel for reaching out to a wider audience of users and to stimulate discussions among stakeholders, ways of improving foreign trade statistics compilation and reporting in the country.

It is our fervent hope that the data provided in this bulletin will meet the needs of users and that it will contribute to improving foreign trade statistics compilation, reporting and dissemination of this country.

Mohamed King Koroma
Statistician General
Statistics Sierra Leone

Acknowledgement

This maiden Bulletin of Foreign Trade Statistics is another landmark in the effort of Statistics Sierra Leone to provide credible, quality and timely trade data to various users for the effective assessment and management of the Sierra Leone economy. It contains useful information for policy-makers, investors and the general public to guide policy-formation geared towards regulating foreign trade activities in the country.

Under the supervision of the Director of Economic Statistics Division, Abu Bakarr Turay, a team of hardworking and dedicated staff of SSL put this Bulletin together; SSL Management therefore acknowledges the immense contribution which the following staff made towards the compilation of this Bulletin: Jinnah Jusu Ngobeh, Head, Foreign Trade Statistics Section, Ibrahim Kamara, Statistician and Saiminatu Ibrahim, Assistant Statistician, of the Foreign Trade Statistics Section. Special thanks go to Mr. Francis N. Brewah, former head of Foreign Trade Statistics Section for his valuable contribution and comments in finalizing this bulletin.

We also acknowledge the great work of the Statistical Clerks of the Foreign Trade Statistics Section.

In addition, we wish to thank all our valuable stakeholders such as NRA, BSL, MTI, Sierra Leone Chamber of Commerce, GDDO, SLIEPA, CMMU, SLPA, NMA and many others whose officials participated in our various validation workshops organized to review the draft Bulletin.

Furthermore, we are very much appreciative of SSL Management team, for facilitating the printing and dissemination of this bulletin.

Finally, we are very grateful to the Government of Sierra Leone for funding the exercise.

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Glossary

BSL	Bank of Sierra Leone
CET	Common External Tariff
CIF	Cost Insurance and Freight
CMMU	Commodity Monitoring and marketing Unit
FOB	Free on Board
GATT	General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade
GGDO	Government Gold and Diamond Office
HS	Harmonized Commodity Description and Coding System
IMTS	International Merchandise Trade Statistics
NRA	National Revenue Authority
NSDS	National Strategy for the Development of Statistics
SITC	Standard International Trade Classification
SSL	Statistics Sierra Leone
SLIEPA	Sierra Leone Investment and Export Promotion Agency

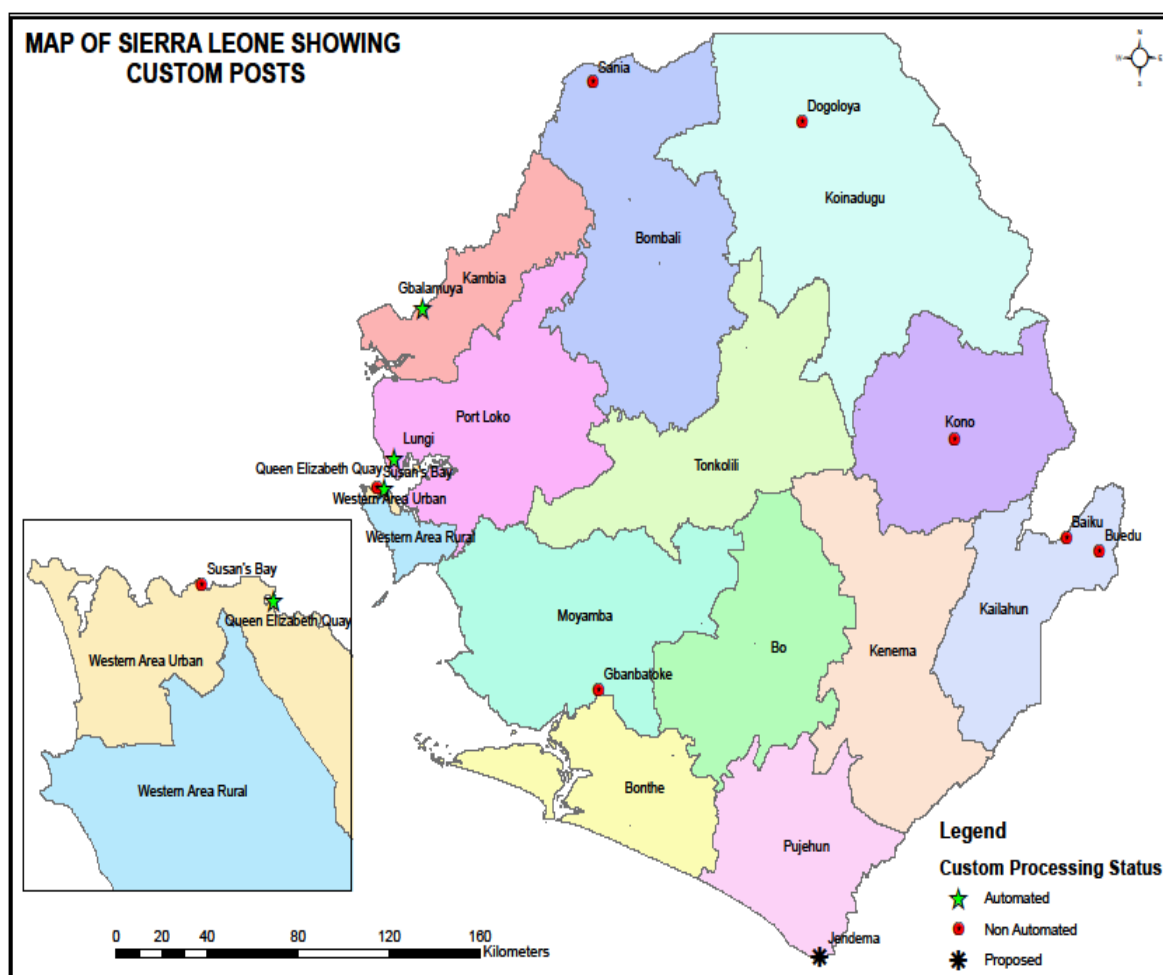
1.0 Geographical Conceptual Issues

This section provides basic information about the geographical location and Customs posts of the country as well as defining relevant foreign trade concepts used in the compilation of foreign trade statistics.

1.1 Geographical Description of Sierra Leone and Customs Posts

Sierra Leone is located on the West Coast of Africa between latitudes 6° 55' and 10° North; and longitudes 10° 16' and 13° 18' West. Sierra Leone is bordered by Republic of Liberia on the South and South-East, Guinea on the North and North-East and the Atlantic Ocean on the West. There are about 210 miles of Atlantic coastline on the south-west. The total land area is approximately 72,000 square kilometers (27, 925 square miles). For administrative purposes, the country is divided into four regions: three provinces (Northern, Southern and Eastern) and Western Area. The country is further subdivided into 14 Administrative districts, 19 local councils and made up of 149 chiefdoms. Figure 1.0 below shows the administrative map of Sierra Leone with Customs operation areas (outstations and Head quarter of Customs operations). There are eleven (11) Customs outstations in the country, ranked by Customs processing status and a feel of revenue generated. In terms of Customs Processing status, Queen Elizabeth II Quay, Lungi International Airport and Gbalamuya are automated, with ASYCUDA++ file system of trade fully operational. Gendema custom border post is proposed to be the next custom post to be automated. The rest of the Custom border posts are said to be non-automated. The Head quarter: Queen Elizabeth II Quay represents 80 to 90 percent of all trade transactions and hence, generating relatively the highest revenue, next is Lungi International Airport followed by Susan's Bay and Gbalamuya in the Kambia district and others not taking informal trade activities into account. The mode of transportation of goods is either by sea, land and air. For mode of transportation by sea, the Queen Elizabeth II Quay is the main point of entry where most international trade transaction takes place. The Freetown International Airport at Lungi is the main point of entry for mode of transportation by air. Transportation by land mostly involves movement between Sierra Leone and the neighboring countries of Guinea and Liberia, and this is much more difficult to monitor given the porous borders. Trade by land has resulted to making a number of porous entries points thereby increasing the volume of informal trade activities.

Figure 1.1: Administrative Map of Sierra Leone showing Customs Posts



2.0 Conceptual Issues

2.1 Background Information

The figures reported in this Bulletin are based on the general system of trade as defined in the International Merchandise Trade Statistics Compilers Manual (IMTS, Rev.2). Under the general trade system, imports include **all goods** entering the economic territory of the compiling country and exports include **all goods** leaving the economic territory of a compiling country. Imported goods valued at c.i.f.-type (that is including transportation and insurance costs up to the border of the compiling country) comprise all goods brought into the Customs territory for home use. Exports valued at f.o.b.-type (that is excluding transport and insurance costs beyond the border of compiling country) are a combination of domestic exports and re-exports. Major domestic exports are agricultural exports which include coffee, cocoa, piassava, timber and tobacco; mineral exports: diamonds, bauxite, rutile, gold, Iron Ore and ilmenite; and marine exports including fish and shrimps. Manufacturing export which includes goods of foreign origin which have been assembled or transformed in the country and goods manufactured in the country. Re-exports are exports of goods of foreign origin which have not been materially transformed while in Sierra Leone.

2.2 The Relevance of Trade Statistics

Different users need different sets of data, ranging from data sets by country and by commodity to aggregated figures. Reliable and timely trade statistics can be used for the following:

- For national and regional policy formulation and planning (example, construction of harbors, airports, roads etc) and transportation statistics
- It is used in the compilation of the Gross Domestic Product (GDP), a key measure of the economic growth and national wellbeing.
- As an input to the compilation of Balance of Payments Statistics (Current account) that measure the level of the country's international trade and investment positions.

- As a gauge in the formulation of trade and trade liberalization related policies as well as regional integration
- It is used to monitor commodity markets, particularly in areas such as agriculture, energy and food processing.
- For market analysis to find supply sources or foreign markets and, in combination with structural business statistics, to determine economic characteristics of traders;

2.3 SSL Foreign Trade Compilation Processes

Before the computerization of Customs operations for the production of Customs Trade Statistics, Sierra Leone compiled and processed trade statistics from bills of entry/declaration received from Customs on weekly basis which were then subjected to coding to ensure data capture using the Eurotrace Editor designed Form that had the fields needed for trade data compilation and processing. Captured data are then printed for quality check. This most of the times involves checking for double records, missing codes and wrong entry. The clean data will then be imported into the Eurotrace Doman, after which further quality checks are made by managing the errors created. Validation rules are then apply to the dataset to ensure that the data files are of quality and ready for dissemination using the Comext Standalone module. With the advent of ASYCUDA++ in 2010, data are then captured using Automated System for Customs Data Management (ASYCUDA) at the entry points. Electronic copies are given to Statistics Sierra Leone which is then processed using EUROTRACE system to produce necessary statistical tables for the country's foreign trade statistics. At the moment, different institutions involve in trade data compilation come up with trade figures. These figures are not in harmony as they cannot be reconciled thus making them questionable. However, modalities are been put in place to establish tri-partite technical committee that include Statistics Sierra Leone, National Revenue Authority-Customs, Bank of Sierra Leone and the Ministry of Trade and Industry to harmonized the methodologies and to determine exclusively the sources of data.

2.4 Limitation of the Data Provided

Data coverage and quality remains a major challenge even with the advent of ASYCUDA system for Customs data and EUROTRACE system for the production of external trade statistics. Given that there are ten Customs outstations/posts at the

moment, only three which includes, Head Office, Lungi Airport and Gbalamuya are fully automated, although steps are being taken to roll over to other Customs post such as Jendema in the Pujehun district. This is compounded by informal trade activities especially at the land border posts. Recent visitation at Customs posts shows that there is little or no arrangement in place for trade data compilation in majority of the Customs outstations.. Data presented in this publication especially on imports represent data received from Customs' single administrative records (bill of entry) and exports figures are mostly augmented with administrative data from Bank of Sierra Leone(cross checked with relevant institutions) since exports data is poorly reported and in some cases not subject to Customs operation areas.

3.0 Presentation and Analysis of Data

This section of the bulletin presents data analysis in the form of charts, line graphs and tables with percentage growth in both the value and volume of trade between two-periods as well as percentage share in the total import and export value to explain the trend in imports and exports flow.

3.1 Trend in imports Value statistics from 2011-2013 in Million Leones

Figure 3.1: Trend in import value statistics (million Leones):2011-2013

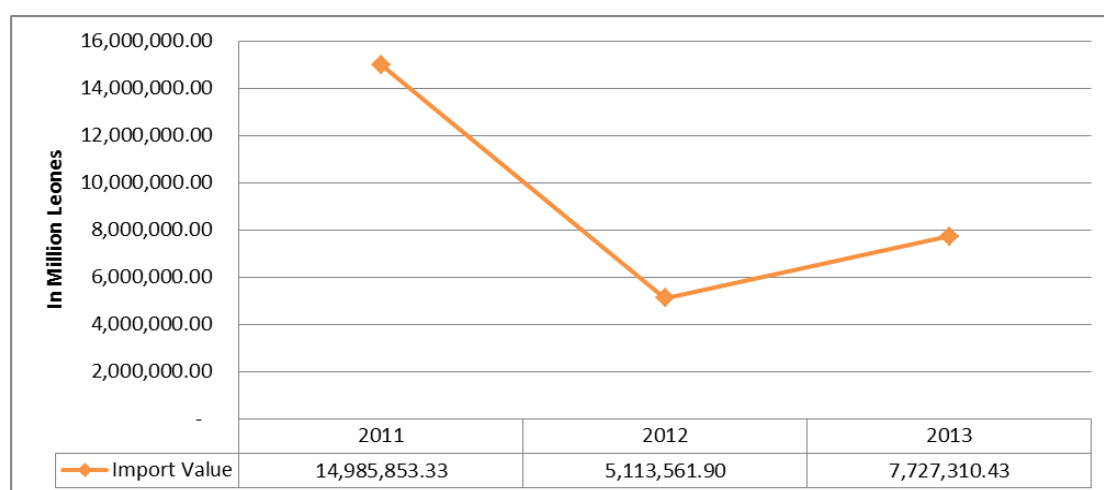


Figure 3.1 above shows the trend in import value for Sierra Leone from 2011 to 2013. Imports were valued at Le 14,985,853.33 million during 2011. The value fell from Le 14,985,853.33 million in 2011, to Le 5,113,561.90 million in 2012, representing a decrease of 65.9 per cent in Leones terms over the level of import in 2011. The import value then rises by 51.1 per cent from Le 5,113,561.90 million in 2012, to Le 7,727,310.43 million in 2013 but still lower than the import value in 2011. Therefore, Sierra Leone's import value in the last three years show a mixed trend where it first increases, then dropped and later rise again.

Table 3.1: Import Value (Million Leones) by SITC from 2011-2013

No	SITC	Year			% Growth		% Share		
		2011	2012	2013	2011/12	2012/13	2011	2012	2013
1	Animal And Vegetable Oils	45,544.44	18,715.51	29,746.74	-58.9	58.9	0.30	0.37	0.38
2	Chemicals and Related Products	68,460.97	31,439.67	47,023.83	-54.1	49.6	0.46	0.61	0.61
3	Crude Material	3,520,442.33	1,897,485.22	3,055,735.02	-46.1	61.0	23.49	37.11	39.54
4	Beverages And Tobacco	65,459.27	33,418.05	32,651.79	-48.9	-2.3	0.44	0.65	0.42
5	Food and Live Animals	820,929.55	283,138.09	293,613.94	-65.5	3.7	5.48	5.54	3.80
6	Machinery And Transport Equip.	1,104,560.58	273,349.54	506,175.68	-75.3	85.2	7.37	5.35	6.55
7	Mineral Fuel And Lubricant	257,788.31	131,441.32	201,609.04	-49.0	53.4	1.72	2.57	2.61
8	Misc. Manufactured articles	6,164,081.32	1,334,561.70	1,663,811.34	-78.3	24.7	41.13	26.10	21.53
9	Manufactured Goods Classified By Material	510,567.55	169,052.15	235,707.50	-66.9	39.4	3.41	3.31	3.05
10	Unclassified Items	462,734.46	157,306.54	255,546.42	-66.0	62.5	3.09	3.08	3.31
Total		14,985,853.33	5,113,561.90	7,727,310.43	-65.9	51.1	100	100	100

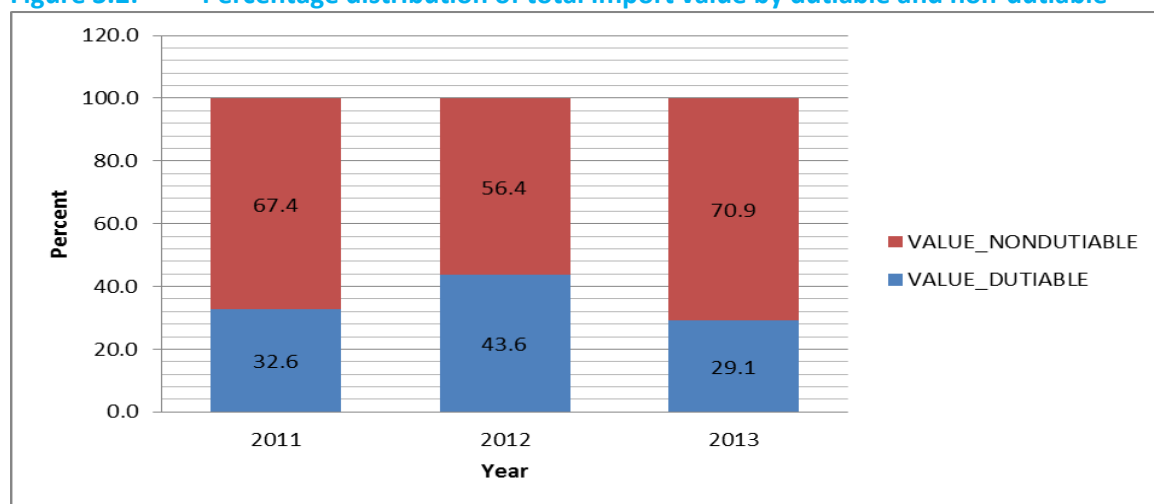
Data Source: Statistics Sierra Leone, NRA Customs

Table 3.1 above shows Sierra Leone's import value by Standard International Trade Classification (SITC). Overall, the country recorded a negative growth of -65.9% between 2011/12 and a positive growth of 51.1% between 2012/13. Between the period 2011/12, all the categories of SITC recorded a negative growth rate indicating that less import of products under each SITC basic heading in 2012, compared with 2011.

Similarly, for period between 2012/13 there were increases in the value of import for the following SITC categories as shown by the positive growth rate for Animal & Vegetable Oil (58.9%), Mineral Fuel and Lubricant (53.4%), Chemicals (49.6%), Manufactured Goods Classified by Materials (39.4%), and Machinery and Transport Equipment (85.2%). The category for which import value increase the most for period 2012/13 is Machinery and Transport Equipment Items (85.2%).

The percentage share of SITC categories in total import value shows almost similar trend for the three-year period under review. In period 2011, Misc. Manufactured Articles and Crude Materials accounts for 41.1 and 23.5% respectively, followed by Machinery and Transport Equipment (7.37%) and Food and Live animals (5.48%). Similarly, for periods 2012 and 2013, the largest share of import value based on SITC group were on Crude materials, Misc.manufactured articles, Food and live animals and Machinery and transport equipment, indicating that more products under these basic headings were imported during the period under review.

Figure 3.2: Percentage distribution of total import value by dutiable and non-dutiable



The result in figure 3.2 above reveals the percentage distribution of Sierra Leone's total import value by dutiable and non-dutiable values for the last three years. The non-dutiable import values for the last three years are far higher than the dutiable import value. Non-dutiable import value account for about 67.4% in 2011, then decrease to 56.4 per cent in 2012 and later it rises again to 70.9% in 2013.

Similarly, dutiable import value account for about 32.6% in 2011, then rises to 43.6% in 2012 and dropped significantly to 29.1% in 2013. This could be attributed to Government fiscal policy of tax concession and duty free waivers given to certain individuals, companies and organizations. Therefore, although the import volume may be huge, but duties are not paid for majority of the imported goods into Sierra Leone during the period under review which has implication on revenue performance.

Table 3.2: Import Value (Million Leones) by country of origin: ECOWAS 2011-2013

NO	ECOWAS	Year			% Growth		% Share		
		2011	2012	2013	2011/12	2012/13	2011	2012	2013
1	BENIN	159,545.71	682,584.11	1,796,474.00	327.8	163.2	1.06	13.35	23.25
2	BURKINA FASO	1,252.87	-	427.20	-100.0		0.01	0.00	0.01
3	CAPE VERDE	-	-	-			0.00	0.00	0.00
4	COTE D IVOIRE	2,137,531.20	415,037.04	133,337.53	-80.6	-67.9	14.26	8.12	1.73
5	GAMBIA	12,528.19	9,494.09	6,902.22	-24.2	-27.3	0.08	0.19	0.09
6	GHANA	331,037.25	28,656.65	31,398.74	-91.3	9.6	2.21	0.56	0.41
7	GUINEA	10,400.46	5,085.16	5,058.99	-51.1	-0.5	0.07	0.10	0.07
8	GUINEA-BISSAU	-	-	-			0.00	0.00	0.00
9	LIBERIA	5,390.80	447.63	2,216.67	-91.7	395.2	0.04	0.01	0.03
19	MALI	-	-	-			0.00	0.00	0.00
11	NIGER	2,178.18	6,775.90	137.00	211.1	-98.0	0.01	0.13	0.00
12	NIGERIA	67,613.03	13,128.67	32,514.47	-80.6	147.7	0.45	0.26	0.42
13	SENEGAL	965,898.39	472,311.59	667,776.90	-51.1	41.4	6.45	9.24	8.64
14	TOGO	250.95	37,806.54	22,985.42	14,965.6	-39.2	0.00	0.74	0.30
	TOTAL	14,985,853.33	5,113,561.90	7,727,310.43	-65.9	51.11	100	100	100

Data Source: Statistics Sierra Leone, NRA Customs

Table 3.2 above shows the level of intra-regional trade between Sierra Leone and ECOWAS member countries. For the period 2011, Sierra Leone imported more goods from Ivory Coast amounting to Le 2,137,531.20 million than any other ECOWAS country, followed by Senegal with import value of Le 965,898.39 million. Ivory Coast and Senegal accounted for about 14.3 and 6.5 per cent respectively of total import value for Sierra Leone.

For period 2012 and 2013, Sierra Leone imported more goods from Benin amounting to Le 682,584.11 million and Le 1,796,474.00 million respectively than any other ECOWAS country, followed by Senegal with import value of Le 472,311.59 million and Le 667,776.90 million respectively. Benin accounts for 13.4 and 23.2 per cent respectively of total import value of Sierra Leone, while Senegal accounts for about 9.2 and 8.6 per cent respectively for the same period under review. Table 3.2 further shows that Sierra Leone did not import from Cape Verde, Guinea-Bissau and Mali during the last three years.

Table 3.3: Export Value (Million Leones) by country of destination: ECOWAS 2011-2013

NO	ECOWAS	Year			% Growth		% Share		
		2011	2012	2013	2011/12	2012/13	2011	2012	2013
1	BENIN	-	-	15.28	-	-	-	-	0.000
2	BURKINA FASO	66.84	-	-	-	-	0.004	-	-
3	CAPE VERDE	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
4	COTE D IVOIRE	592.18	-	0.10	-	-	0.039	-	0.000
5	GAMBIA	667.46	556.02	212,661.02	-16.70	38,147.01	0.044	0.011	2.57
6	GHANA	72,462.11	0.08	110.03	-99.9	137,437.50	4.764	0.000	0.001
7	GUINEA	7,088.15	32,834.67	57,535.33	363.23	75.23	0.466	0.674	0.695
8	GUINEA-BISSAU	14.57	-	-	-100.00	-	0.001	-	-
9	LIBERIA	5,614.13	267.75	2,440.78	-95.23	811.59	0.369	0.005	0.029
19	MALI	-	87.58	52.45		-40.12	-	0.002	0.001
11	NIGER	212.89	-	-	-100.00	-	0.014	-	-
12	NIGERIA	309.24	250.08	469.45	-19.13	87.72	0.020	0.005	0.006
13	SENEGAL	297.01	0.11	2.52	-99.96	2,288.41	0.020	0.000	0.000
14	TOGO	-	-	-	0.00	-	-	-	-
TOTAL		1,521,014.38	4,871,104.97	8,276,288.23	220.25	69.91	100	100	100

Data Source: Statistics Sierra Leone, NRA Customs & BSL

Table 3.3 above shows Sierra Leone's export value by partner countries within ECOWAS region during the last three year. Overall, Sierra Leone's total export were valued at Le 1,521,014.38 million in 2011, then increased to Le4,871,104.97 million in 2012, and again rises to Le 8,276,288.23 million in 2013. The country recorded a positive growth rate of 220.25 and 69.91% in 2012 and 2013 respectively.

In 2011, the country exported more commodities to Ghana which were valued at Le 72,462.11 million, accounting for about 4.7% of total export than any other ECOWAS member country. This was followed by Guinea accounting for about 0.46% of total export.

In period 2012 and 2013, the country exported more to Guinea which was valued at Le 32,834.67, accounting for about 0.67% of total export value and in 2013, the country exported more to the Gambia valued at Le212,661.02, accounting for about 2.57% of total export value. The percentage share of export value to ECOWAS member countries in total export is not more than 10% for each year during the last three years.

Table 3.4: Top 10 Countries of Import (Million Leones) from 2011-2013

2011				2012			2013		
Rank	Country	Value	% Share	Country	Value	% Share	Country	Value	% Share
1	COTE D'IVOIRE	2,137,531.20	14.3	BENIN	682,584.11	13.3	BENIN	1,796,474.00	23.1
2	UK	1,877,853.94	12.5	UAE	621,962.05	12.2	UK	846,278.43	10.6
3	CHINA	1,696,880.47	11.3	SENEGAL	472,311.59	9.2	SENEGAL	667,776.90	8.7
4	SOUTH AFRICA	1,309,074.77	8.7	COTE D'IVOIRE	415,037.04	8.1	UAE	648,266.33	8.5
5	BELGIUM	1,090,829.98	7.3	CHINA	377,757.26	7.4	CHINA	579,081.71	7.6
6	SENEGAL	965,898.39	6.4	UK	364,442.60	7.1	INDIA	435,151.66	5.7
7	UAE	890,312.37	5.9	USA	243,803.73	4.8	LEBANON	311,954.16	4.0
8	USA	508,902.64	3.4	SOUTH AFRICA	217,185.23	4.2	USA	287,382.46	3.8
9	NETHERLANDS	392,272.18	2.6	HOLLAND	207,152.04	4.1	NETHERLANDS	263,681.03	3.5
10	INDIA	383,185.42	2.6	INDIA	195,354.82	3.8	AUSTRALIA	208,962.47	2.7
Total		14,985,853.33	100		5,113,561.90	100		7,727,310.43	100

Data Source: Statistics Sierra Leone, NRA Customs & BSL

Table 3.4 above shows Sierra Leone's Ten (10) top partner countries of import and their percentage share in total import value for the last three years. For the period 2011, the ten top countries of import together accounted for about 75% of total import, with the first three countries been COTE D IVOIRE, United Kingdom and China each accounting for 14.3 , 12.5 and 11.3 per cent respectively as share of total import .

For period 2012,the ten top countries of import together accounted for about 74.2% of total import, with Benin, United Arab Emirates and Senegal each accounting for 13.3 , 12.2 and 9.2 per cent respectively as share of total import value. Similarly, in 2013 the ten top countries of import together accounted for about 78.2% of total import value, with the first three countries been Benin, UK and Senegal each accounting for 23.1, 10.6 and 8.7 per cent respectively as share of total import value.

Table 3.5: Top 10 Countries of Export (Million Leones) from 2011-2013

2011				2012			2013		
Rank	Country	Value	% Share	Country	Value	% Share	Country	Value	% Share
1	CHINA	1,107,393.76	72.81	CHINA	1,621,862.39	33.30	CHINA	3,340,856.51	40.37
2	HOLLAND	141,672.75	9.31	UK	731,912.45	15.03	UK	287,474.76	3.47
3	GHANA	72,462.11	4.76	SWAZILAND	130,713.68	2.68	GAMBIA	212,661.02	2.57
4	INDIA	39,023.18	2.57	BELGIUM	104,336.09	2.14	GUINEA	57,535.33	0.70
5	SOUTH AFRICA	19,043.55	1.25	HOLLAND	84,294.90	1.73	SOUTH AFRICA	21,226.21	0.26
6	KOREA	18,905.67	1.24	SWITZERLAND	60,468.49	1.24	CANADA	12,381.30	0.15
7	FRANCE	13,156.05	0.86	INDIA	52,446.71	1.08	HOLLAND	11,591.40	0.14
8	GUINEA	7,088.15	0.47	KOREA	35,550.25	0.73	SWITZERLAND	7,425.07	0.09
9	BELGIUM	5,686.61	0.37	GUINEA	32,834.67	0.67	BELGIUM	5,974.68	0.07
10	GERMANY	4,095.26	0.27	SOUTH AFRICA	31,133.21	0.64	USA	4,308.25	0.05
Total		1,521,014.38	100		4,871,104.97	100		8,276,288.23	100

Data Source: Statistics Sierra Leone, NRA Customs & BSL

Table 3.5 above shows Sierra Leone's Ten (10) top partner countries of export and their percentage share in total export value for the last three years. For period 2011, more than half of the country's commodities were exported to China accounting for about 72.8 per cent of total export. This was followed by Holland, Ghana, India and South Africa each accounting for 9.3, 4.8, 2.6 and 1.2 per cent respectively of total export.

In 2012, majority of Sierra Leone products were exported to china, accounting for about 33.3 per cent of total export value. This was followed by UK, Swaziland, Belgium and Holland each accounting for 15.03, 2.68, 2.14 and 1.723 per cent respectively of total export value.

In 2013, most of Sierra Leone's products were again exported to China, accounting for about 40.37 per cent of total export value. . This was followed by UK, Gambia, Guinea and South Africa each accounting for 3.47, 2.57, 0.70 and 0.26 per cent respectively of total export value.

3.2 Trend in exports Value statistics from 2011-2013 in Million Leones

Figure 3.2.1: Trend in export value from 2011-2013

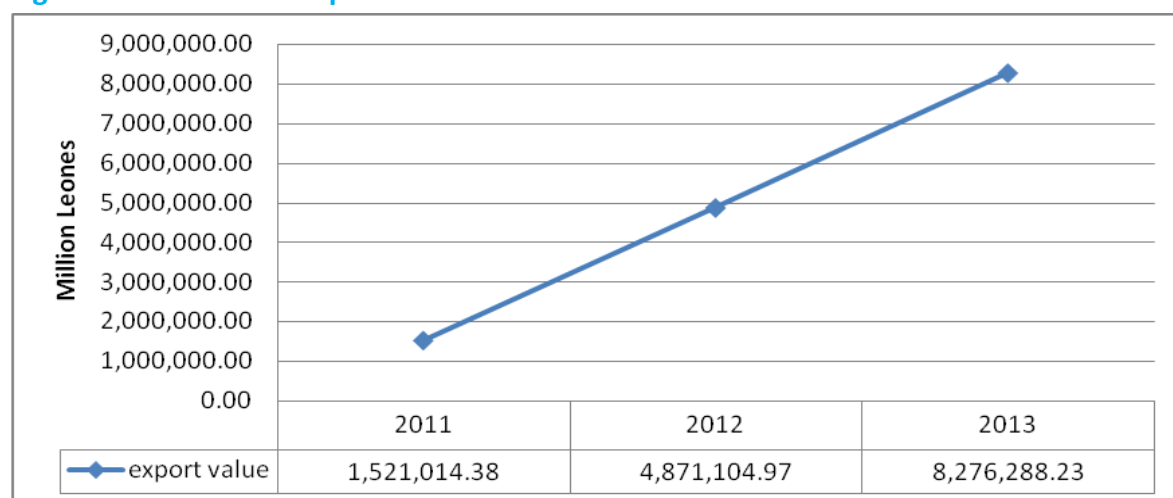


Figure 3.2.1 above shows the trend in export value for Sierra Leone from 2011 to 2013. Total export which is the sum of both export and re-export were valued at Le 1,521,014.38 million during 2011. The export value rises significantly from Le 1,521,014.38 in 2011 to Le 4,871,104.97 million Leones in 2012, representing an increase of more than 200% in Leones terms over the value of export in 2011. The export value then rises again by 69.9 per cent from Le 4,871,104.97 million in 2012, to Le 8,276,288.23 million in 2013. Hence, Sierra Leone 's export value in the last three years shows an upward trend were it increases continuously from 2011 to 2013, indicating an expansion of output as a result of increase in the level of economic activities in the country.

Table 3.2.1: Export Value for Major Domestic products (Million Leones) from 2011-2013

Commodities	Year			% Growth		% Share		
	2011	2012	2013	2011/12	2012/13	2011	2012	2013
1) Mineral Products	1,047,741.9	3,440,661.4	7,729,620.69	228.39	124.66	68.9	70.6	93.4
1.1 Diamond	566,118.7	701,957.0	804,293.34	12.96	2.97	37.2	14.4	9.7
1.2 Gold	31,687.7	24,943.8	15,921.95	-0.64	-0.26	2.1	0.5	0.2
1.3 Iron Ore	65,224.7	1,550,747.4	4,613,287.50	141.78	89.01	4.3	31.8	55.7
1.4 Bauxite	169,602.9	74,245.2	59,860.66	-9.10	-0.42	11.2	1.5	0.7
1.5 Rutile	150,140.2	884,911.1	561,273.02	70.13	-9.41	9.9	18.2	6.8
1.6 Ilmenite	19,383.6	16,264.7	12,624.16	-0.30	-0.11	1.3	0.3	0.2
1.7 Zircom	45,584.2	14,925.0	1,301.09	-2.93	-0.40	3.0	0.3	0.0
1.8 Other Minerals	-	172,667.2	1,661,058.95	16.48	43.26	0	3.5	20.1
2) Agricultural Products	328,646.98	1,110,527.36	439,980.17	74.63	-19.49	21.6	22.8	5.3
2.1 Coffee	8,695.1	16,709.0	12,183.67	0.76	-0.13	0.6	0.3	0.1
2.2 Cocoa	190,188.0	111,141.1	38,897.29	-7.54	-2.10	12.5	2.3	0.5
2.3 Piassava	42.7	-	64.80	0.00	0.00	0.0	0.0	0.0
2.4 Fish and Shrimps	3,269.2	2,035.2	1,369.37	-0.12	-0.02	0.2	0.0	0.0
2.6 Other Products	126,452.0	980,642.1	387,529.83	81.53	-17.24	8.3	20.1	4.7
Total	1,521,014.38	4,871,104.97	8,276,288.23	319.74	98.97	100	100	100

Source: Statistics Sierra Leone, NRA Customs & BSL

Table 3.2.1 above shows the performance of Sierra Leone major domestic export during the last three years. For mineral export, there has been a continuous increase in the export value during the period under review.

In 2011, mineral exports were valued at Le 1,047,741.9 million Leones, which rises significantly to Le 3,440,661.4 million Leones in 2012 recording a percentage growth of 228 per cent and further increases to Le 7,729,620.6 million Leones in 2013 with a percentage growth of 124 per cent. Furthermore, the share of mineral export in total export value also continue to increase from 68.9 per cent in 2011, to 70.6 per cent in 2012 and then rises again to 93.4 per cent in 2013.

For Agricultural export, there has been a mixed trend in the export value during the period under review. In 2011, Agricultural export were valued at Le 328,646.98 million Leones, which rises considerably to Le 1,110,527.36 million Leones in 2012, recording a growth rate of 74 per cent and fell to Le 439,980.17 in 2013 with a negative growth rate of 19.49 per cent. In addition, the share of agricultural export in total export value increases slightly from 21.6 per cent in 2011 to 22.8 per cent in 2012 but dropped significantly to 5.3 per cent in 2013.

Table 3.2.2: Import value by region (in million Leones) from 2011-2013

Region	year			% Growth		% Share		
	2011	2012	2013	2011/12	2012/13	2011	2012	2013
1) Europe	4,421,273.98	1,021,293.16	1,779,519.97	-76.9	74.2	29.5	20.0	23.0
1.1 EU Countries	4,421,273.98	1,021,293.16	1,779,519.97	-76.9	74.2	29.5	20.0	23.0
2) Africa	5,188,409.81	1,944,346.23	2,926,154.15	-62.5	50.5	34.6	38.0	37.9
2.1 South African Countries	1,360,756.04	229,147.20	127,944.85	-83.2	-44.2	9.1	4.5	1.7
2.2 West Africa	3,693,627.01	1,671,327.36	2,699,229.14	-54.8	61.5	24.6	32.7	34.9
2.3 Central Africa	9,502.18	150.43	72.88	-98.4	-51.6	0.1	0.0	0.0
2.4 East Africa	7,524.70	1,091.06	6,429.80	-85.5	489.3	0.1	0.0	0.1
2.5 North Africa	116,999.87	42,630.17	92,477.49	-63.6	116.9	0.8	0.8	1.2
3) America	868,984.43	394,559.54	374,162.34	-54.6	-5.2	5.8	7.7	4.8
3.1 North America	680,875.27	315,480.11	313,173.05	-53.7	-0.7	4.5	6.2	4.1
3.2 Latin America	188,109.16	79,079.43	60,989.29	-58.0	-22.9	1.3	1.5	0.8
4) Asia	4,289,765.67	1,675,475.84	2,407,109.88	-60.9	43.7	28.6	32.8	31.2
4.1 Asia-Countries	4,289,765.67	1,675,475.84	2,422,810.69	-60.9	44.6	28.6	32.8	31.4
5) Oceania	217,419.45	77,887.14	240,364.09	-64.2	208.6	1.5	1.5	3.1
5.1 Oceania Countries	217,419.45	77,887.14	240,364.09	-64.2	208.6	1.5	1.5	3.1
Total	14,985,853.33	5,113,561.91	7,727,310.41	-65.9	51.1	100	100	100

Source: Custom, BSL & Statistics Sierra Leone

Table 3.2.2 above shows the country's import value by region during the last three years. All the regions recorded a negative growth rate in 2012, indicating that less products were imported in 2012 compared to 2011. Furthermore, in 2013 while other regions such as Europe, Africa and Asia all recorded a positive growth rate in import value of 74.2, 50.5 and 43.7 per cent respectively, America still continue to record a negative growth rate of -5.2 per cent.

In addition, Sierra Leone's trade performance with Africa region in particular has improved during the last three years as indicated by the increase in the import percentage share of 34.6, 38.0 and 37.9 in 2011, 2012 and 2013 respectively.

In 2011, the country imported a significant amount of goods from Europe accounting for about 29.5 per cent of total import value, while that of Asia accounts for about 28.6 per cent of total import value slightly less than Europe.

In 2012 and 2013, apart from Africa region, the country imported more goods from Asia than Europe and America regions as indicated in table 7 above.

3.2.1 Export volume of major domestic products from 2011-2013

The analysis by export volume is important because it gives us an idea of the real output measure devoid of inflation. That is, whether the increase or decrease in the export value is as a result of a change in the world market price of the commodity or not.

Table 3.2.3: Export volume of major domestic products from 2011-2013

Commodities	Year			% Growth	
	2011	2012	2013	2011/12	2012/13
1) Mineral Products					
Diamond	355.3	532.6	604.74	49.9	13.6
Gold	5,287.8	4,534.5	3,099.53	-14.2	-31.6
Iron Ore	339,327.0	5,203,492.2	13,581,075.20	1,433.5	161.0
Bauxite	1,421,765.8	715,525.6	447,848.51	-49.7	-37.4
Rutile	44,619.0	84,889.1	149,535.29	90.3	76.2
Ilmenite	19,089.8	10,005.0	12,168.83	-47.6	21.6
Zircon	13,025.5	456,351.8	158,500.00	3,403.5	-65.3
Other Minerals	-	892,606.2	3,248,469.0	-	263.9
2) Agricultural Products					
Coffee	3,787.9	3,254.5	2,541.00	-14.1	-21.9
Cocoa	17,999.9	11,387.2	4,196.71	-36.7	-63.1
Piassava	-	-	80	-	-
Fish and Shrimps	2,121.8	7,727.0	7,350.8	264.2	-4.9

Note: Diamond in (000'carats), Gold in (Ounce) and all others in (M.tons)

Table 3.2.3 above shows the actual production volume of Sierra Leone's major domestic exports for the last three years. For Agricultural products such as coffee and cocoa, the actual volume exported fell continuously from 3,787.9 and 17,999.9 M.tons in 2011 to 3,254.5 and 11,387.2 M.tons in 2012 and then to 2,541.0 and 4,196.7 M.tons in 2013 respectively, recording a negative growth rate of 14.1 and 36.6 per cent in 2012 as well as 21.9 and 63.1 per cent negative growth rate in 2013. There was no piassava export in 2011 and 2012, only in 2013 which account for about 80 M.tons.

However, the volume of fish and shrimps exported increased significantly from 2,121.8 M.tons in 2011 to 7,727.0 M.tons in 2012 and then fell slightly to 7,350.8 M.tons in 2013, recording a negative growth rate of 4.9 per cent.

For mineral products such as Iron Ore, diamond and rutile, the actual volume of export increased continuously from 339,327.0 M.tons, 355.3 carats and 44,619.0 M.tons in 2011 to 5,203,492.2 M.tons, 532.6 carats and 84,889.1 M.tons in 2012 and then to 13,581,075.20 M.tons, 604.7 carats and 149,535.29 in 2013 respectively. All three products recorded a positive growth rate during the period under review.

However, actual export volume of Gold and bauxite decreased continuously from 5,287.8 ounce and 1,421,765.8 M.tons in 2011, to 4,534.5 ounce and 715,525.6 M.tons in 2012, and then to 3,099.53 ounce and 447,848.51 M.tons in 2013 respectively, with each recording a negative growth rate of 14.2 and 49.7 per cent in 2012 and 31.6 and 37.4 per cent in 2013 respectively.

Table 3.2.4: Top 10 Commodities of Export (Million Leones) from 2011-2013

2011				2012			2013		
Rank	Product	Value	% Share	Product	Value	% Share	Product	Value	% Share
1	Diamond	566,118.67	37.2	Iron Ore	1,550,747.37	31.8	Iron Ore	4,613,287.50	55.7
2	Cocoa	190,187.96	12.5	Other Agric. Products	980,642.09	20.1	Other Minerals	1,661,058.95	20.1
3	Bauxite	169,602.87	11.2	Rutile	884,911.11	18.2	Diamond	804,293.34	9.7
4	Rutile	150,140.20	9.9	Diamond	701,957.00	14.4	Rutile	561,273.02	6.8
5	Other Agric. Product	126,451.99	8.3	Other Minerals	172,667.21	3.5	Other Agric. Products	387,529.83	4.7
6	Iron Ore	65,224.67	4.3	Cocoa	111,141.08	2.3	Bauxite	59,860.66	0.7
7	Zircon	45,584.21	3.0	Bauxite	74,245.25	1.5	Cocoa	38,897.29	0.5
8	Gold	31,687.68	2.1	Gold	24,943.82	0.5	Gold	15,921.95	0.2
9	Ilmenite	19,383.61	1.3	Coffee	16,709.01	0.3	Ilmenite	12,624.16	0.2
10	Coffee	8,695.09	0.6	Ilmenite	16,264.72	0.3	Coffee	12,183.67	0.1
Total		1,521,014.38	100			4,871,104.97	100	8,276,288.23	100

Source: Statistics Sierra Leone, BSL

Table 3.2.4 above shows Sierra Leone ten top commodities of export during the last three years. In 2011, diamond accounted for the highest export value of Le 566,118.67 million Leones with 37.2 per cent share in total export value. This was followed by Cocoa and Bauxite with export values of Le 190,187.96 million Leones and Le 169,602.87 million Leones respectively accounting for 12.5 per cent and 11.2 per cent share in total export value.

For period 2012, Iron Ore accounted for the highest export value of Le 1,550,747.37 million Leones with a significant increase in percentage share in total export value from 4.3 per cent in 2011 to 31.8 per cent in 2012. This was followed by other agriculture products, rutile and diamond respectively with percentage share of 20.1 per cent, 18.2 per cent and 14.4 per cent respectively in total export value.

In 2013, Iron Ore accounted for more than half of Sierra Leone's total export value amounting to Le 4,613,287.50 million Leones with 55.7 per cent share in total export value. This was followed by other minerals, diamond and rutile respectively with percentage share of 20.1 per cent, 9.7 per cent and 6.8 per cent respectively in total export value.

4.0 Trade Balance

The country's trade balance is measured as the total value of export minus the total value of import. In other words, trade balance is simply the net exports as it tells us how a country's trade departs from the benchmark of equal imports and exports. It is mostly used in the current account of the balance of payment (BOP) compilation that shows the country's financial position with rest of the world.

Figure 4.1: Import, Export and Visible Trade Balance 2011-2013

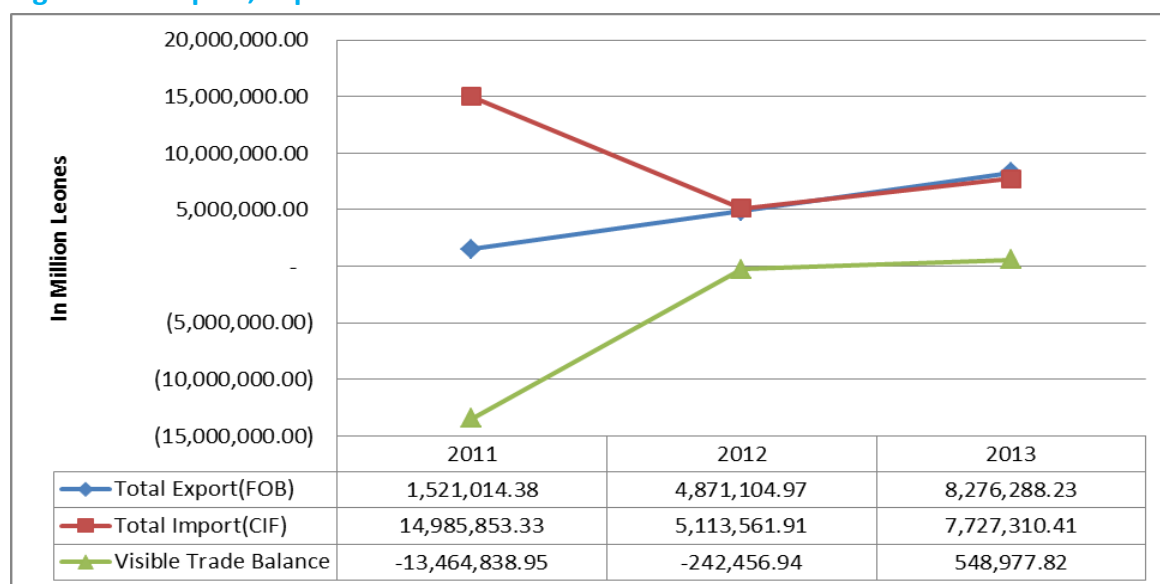


Figure 4.1 above shows the total visible trade balance during the last three years. It can be clearly seen from the graph that trade deficit has improved significantly over the period 2011-2013. Over the period 2011-2012, a negative net export (trade deficit) was recorded. This implies that the country imported more goods than it exported to the rest of the world. In 2013, a positive net export (trade Surplus) was recorded as a result of the 69.9 per cent increase in export value from Le 4,871,104.97 in 2012 to Le 8,276,288.23 in 2013. The positive net export (trade surplus) could be attributed to the huge Iron Ore export in 2013. Trade balance although negative in 2012 but continue to narrow until it became positive in 2013. This implies an improvement in the terms of trade indicating that the country export now exceeds it import from rest of the world.

5.0 Key Findings and Recommendations of Visit to Custom Border Post

5.1 Introduction

The trade section has its annual usual activity of visiting the custom border post across the country in order to collect trade data available at the various custom border posts as well as to discuss with custom officers some of the challenging issues related to trade data compilation at each custom border post. The custom border post visit is very important especially when there are only three (3) custom posts (Cline town, Lungi and Gbalamuya) that have been automated with Asycuda++ fully operational. This means that trade data obtained from the other custom border posts apart from the three automated customs are not included in our foreign trade statistics, hence under estimation of our import and export trade data. Therefore, the main suppose of the custom border visit was to have an idea of the volume of trade taking place across the Sierra Leone-Liberia and Guinea borders.

5.2 Key findings

- There are laid down custom formalities and processes followed by custom officers when traders arrived with their goods at the custom post.
- No trade data is recorded at the custom post, only receipt of payment of custom duties was available indicating that the NRA custom officers are mainly interested in revenue collection.
- The custom representatives/volunteers who are mostly at the post are not well knowledgeable in custom procedures.
- The borders are very porous as there are so many illegal entry points.
- Okada riders carry goods from vehicle at night when the border is officially close.

- Patrol teams monitoring the illegal crossing points are mostly attacked by youth with cutlasses and acid water.
- The police officers at the custom post are not helping the situation much.
- There is also sea route people use to bring in goods which is not manned at all.
- 100% physical examination is not done at some of custom border post.
- Goods that are mostly exported through the border post are agricultural products such as garri, pepper, oranges, bananas, potatoes, vegetables, palm oil and other perishables goods.

5.3 Challenges

Some of the challenges that serve as impediment to trade at the various custom border post includes the following:

- Poor road condition especially the roads going to Koindu and Gendema custom border posts.
- Inadequate NRA personnel deployed at the custom border post.
- No recording of trade data at the various custom border post the team visited.
- Police officers not very much cooperating with custom officers at the border post.
- Involvement of community leaders or local authorities in revenue collection at the post.
- Lack of adequate logistics for custom officer and patrol teams to monitor porous or illegal crossing points.

- Controlling of motorbike riders as well as boat owners who are actively involved in transportation of goods into the country through by passing the official custom post.
- Installation of Asycuda++ at some of the custom border post.

5.4 Recommendations

- The Kenema-Gendema and Kailahun-Koindu roads should be repaired in order to attract people involve in trade across the border to use these routes.
- The NRA should send additional personnel at the Koindu and Gendema border posts to be deploy at the other legal entry points that do not have any custom officer. This can help to reduce smuggling.
- The customs representatives or volunteers recruited from the communities should be given a formal training in customs procedures so that they can be more efficient and effective in their work.
- All custom border posts where asycuda++ is not yet operational should be sending their Baggage Assessment Form (BAF) in which trade data is recorded to custom office at the headquarter so that it can be captured electronically and be included in the monthly asycuda++ files sent to Statistics Sierra Leone.
- Security personnel to cooperate with custom officers at the border post in order to minimize the use of illegal entry points.
- Custom officers should also be provided with adequate logistics to facilitate their movement between one legal entry point and another with their respective district.
- It is also recommended that if possible, 100% examination be done at the custom border posts to be able to determine actual volume of import. Therefore during the rainy season, canopy should be provided at the custom border post to facilitate this process.

6.0 Statistical Annex Tables

Table 6.1: Import Value (Million Leones) by country of Origin: South America

Country	Year					
	2011		2012		2013	
	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value(in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)
BOLIVIA	2,809.13	916.17	1,254.23	486.76	1,764.69	343.83
CHILE	121,844.92	20,526.36	53,252.27	11,145.59	42,093.51	39,438.36
COLOMBIA	330.44	76.53	3,941.19	1,081.59	1,075.31	295.95
GUYANA	366.77	31.52	821.94	114.85	213.70	16.08
PARAGUAY	68.92	20.67	452.22	124.35	141.27	63.09
SURINAME	3,684.34	40.83	-	-	-	-
VENEZUELA	28,662.02	3,646.62	1,570.73	526.89	-	-

Source: NRA Customs & Statistics Sierra Leone

Table 6.2: Import Value (Million Leones) by country of Origin: European Union

Country	Year					
	2011		2012		2013	
	Value(in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)
ANDORRA	2,741.68	137.53	158.79	51.15	-	-
ALBANIA	95.65	24.49	205.93	17.13	1,830.00	28.75
AUSTRIA	3,871.86	244.39	-	-	-	-
AZERBAIJAN	276.07	108.87	-	-	-	-
BELGIUM	1,090,829.98	203,448.21	170,559.81	3,845.82	188,242.91	7,727.32
BULGARIA	47.73	1.70	105.09	20.92	-	-
BELARUS	-	-	-	-	72.32	40.10
SWITZERLAND	85,590.72	32,919.38	19,759.34	9,062.07	4,725.01	2,378.45
CYPRUS	545.76	18.45	-	-	566.55	31.07
CZECH REPUBLIC	7,732.02	14.41	2,376.45	9.68	3,021.33	13.09
GERMANY	181,523.32	19,938.62	40,325.56	3,762.47	47,916.02	1,192.14
DENMARK	259,344.14	3,780.83	29,030.52	1,442.37	18,963.75	609.89
ESTONIA	1,543.95	505.87	-	-	-	-
SPAIN	115,343.99	77,823.61	46,044.32	32,099.65	116,739.35	3,950.05
FINLAND	17,608.88	290.14	41.76	0.11	5,439.72	122.02
FRANCE	138,534.32	3,078.88	58,795.29	864.11	170,766.17	949.25
UNITED KINGDOM	1,877,853.94	37,135.57	364,442.60	6,093.02	846,278.43	7,183.02
GEORGIA	-	-	2,441.10	162.85	1,982.73	27.00
GREECE	2,914.06	38.90	-	-	1,631.53	207.05
HUNGARY	241.15	28.97	49.81	0.84	1.80	0.07
IRELAND	11,683.69	281.02	1,670.58	42.81	1,686.46	62.96

Table 6.2: (Cont'd)

Country	Year					
	2011		2012		2013	
	Value(in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)
ICELAND	192.04	38.43	-	-	-	-
ITALY	137,884.08	5,285.05	12,778.13	1,914.99	15,967.77	1,308.05
LITHUANIA	30.83	24.00	18.52	0.18	800.05	74.19
LUXEMBOURG	348.65	15.63	1,005.38	46.89	377.63	15.63
LATVIA	236.37	24.67	-	-	7.67	0.03
MALTA	1,353.71	29.15	914.45	72.24	588.55	101.17
NETHERLANDS	392,272.18	34,902.88	207,152.04	17,293.38	263,681.03	8,665.59
NORWAY	18,079.60	30,422.55	1,641.11	14.82	2,093.02	9.18
POLAND	10,151.91	883.83	5,261.36	873.30	5,424.04	946.78
PORTUGAL	908.56	62.75	189.72	15.62	1,504.64	148.03
ROMANIA	25,067.96	439.59	6,678.34	199.59	15,084.77	13.77
SWEDEN	47,530.84	692.41	38,222.34	235.19	34,712.89	455.70
SLOVENIA	-	-	1,052.21	2.50	11,803.55	83.63
SLOVAKIA	-	-	6.19	0.01	-	-
SAN MARINO	57.95	0.27	-	-	-	-
UKRAINE	2,328.87	853.50	2,702.30	799.65	648.40	320.50

Source: NRA Customs & Statistics Sierra Leone

Table 6.3: Import Value (Million Leones) by Country of Origin: Asia

Country	Year					
	2011		2012		2013	
	Value(in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)
AE:UNITED ARAB EMIRATES	890,312.37	31,412.05	621,962.05	22,674.73	648,266.33	18,148.21
BD:BANGLADESH	1,901.40	372.40	1,380.17	237.20	3,675.10	267.18
BH:BAHRAIN	-	-	-	-	1,064.00	13.23
CN:CHINA	1,696,880.47	118,775.96	377,757.26	37,763.49	579,081.71	33,512.65
ID:INDONESIA	46,017.33	3,980.64	11,934.18	2,193.03	13,816.94	3,280.36
IL:ISRAEL	140.76	6.25	-	-	213.64	10.02
IN:INDIA	383,185.42	32,632.95	195,354.82	17,441.91	435,151.66	33,097.54
IR:IRAN, ISLAMIC REPUBLIC OF	5,477.40	229.04	1,105.68	271.76	45.91	11.45
JP:JAPAN	62,351.37	2,035.52	62,883.48	191.20	54,294.34	109.22
KH:CAMBODIA	-	-	-	-	406.60	96.27
KP:KOREA, DEMOCRATIC PEOPLE'S REP. OF	130,931.67	1,006.79	1,029.73	37.07	6,725.17	91.31
KR:KOREA, REPUBLIC OF	164,374.66	1,656.31	75,299.63	1,212.13	17,282.08	1,116.17
KW:KUWAIT	959.19	22.41	-	-	-	-
LB:LEBANON	341,293.33	7,102.95	169,165.90	3,571.60	311,954.16	7,422.50
LK:SRI LANKA	2,771.34	288.45	4,945.73	426.25	7,204.65	330.10
MM:MYANMAR	-	-	-	-	105.96	49.66
MY:MALAYSIA	51,411.57	5,907.30	21,048.33	2,179.64	40,394.75	4,699.22
OM:OMAN	20,338.72	543.06	3,150.18	542.95	201.86	58.08
PK:PAKISTAN	123,260.60	56,873.96	28,240.60	11,421.60	40,434.87	10,448.10
QA:QATAR	1,393.83	203.09	464.67	74.25	3,664.60	344.50
RU:RUSSIAN FEDERATION	1,027.85	3.16	-	-	-	-
SA:SAUDI ARABIA	17,280.32	2,504.09	7,385.54	1,478.14	16,164.68	2,792.04
SG:SINGAPORE	25,242.97	3,401.96	30,494.05	2,013.59	131,565.98	2,106.25
SY:SYRIAN ARAB REPUBLIC	3,021.06	47.48	-	-	-	-
TH:THAILAND	52,314.93	7,917.99	4,482.51	935.94	23,192.23	4,280.70
TR:TURKEY	106,336.91	69,548.97	31,860.06	10,100.79	44,748.09	13,594.58
UY:URUGUAY	28,662.02	3,646.62	1,570.73	526.89	-	-
VN:VIET NAM	131,338.35	56,671.68	7,744.41	19,118.08	26,899.55	2,910.37
YE:YEMEN	-	-	-	-	768.68	52.09

Source: NRA Customs & Statistics Sierra Leone

Table 6.4: Import Value (Million Leones) by country of Origin: Africa

Country	Year					
	2011		2012		2013	
	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)
BF:BURKINA FASO	1,252.87	5.43	-	-	427.2	0.86
BJ:BENIN	159,545.71	197	682,584.11	309	1,796,474.00	450.52
BW:BOTSWANA	-	-	123.69	0.16	-	-
CG:CONGO	-	-	150.43	0.64	-	-
CI:COTE D'IVOIRE	2,137,531.20	5,473.19	415,037.04	18,607.68	133,337.53	2,665.09
CM:CAMEROON	314.52	6.61	-	-	-	-
DZ:ALGERIA	3,073.10	1,264.25	3,380.36	445.5	20,285.90	2,186.16
EG:EGYPT	68,616.87	5,702.81	16,862.15	1,755.40	11,951.91	1,398.99
ER:ERITREA	5.44	0.35	0.95	0.13	442.25	143.65
ET:ETHIOPIA	-	-	45.4	6	-	-
GA:GABON	-	-	-	-	72.88	11.84
GH:GHANA	331,037.25	3,009.93	28,656.65	1,043.98	31,398.74	783.16
GM:GAMBIA	12,528.19	1,880.36	9,494.09	701.99	6,902.22	1,259.29
GN:GUINEA	10,400.46	481,266.30	5,085.16	2,930.83	5,058.99	3,487.95
KE:KENYA	2,584.72	161.26	335.86	6.11	2,283.15	91.52
LR:LIBERIA	5,390.80	137.21	447.63	33.2	2,216.67	45.94
MA:MOROCCO	6,986.02	615.33	1,844.24	364.17	16,889.44	1,192.96
MR:MAURITANIA	-	-	-	-	62.06	0.4
MW:MALAWI	-	-	344.09	3	-	-
MZ:MOZAMBIQUE	1,283.46	77.67	-	-	-	-
NA:NAMIBIA	-	-	531.11	0.9	-	-
NE:NIGER	2,178.18	25.98	6,775.90	6.35	137	41.16
NG:NIGERIA	67,613.03	5,259.14	13,128.67	837.5	32,514.47	1,396.37
SD:SUDAN	2,767.48	8.07	-	-	23,789.43	277.63
SN:SENEGAL	965,898.39	11,076.83	472,311.59	3,125.21	667,776.90	2,562.23
ST:SAO TOME AND PRINCIPE	9,187.66	432.61	-	-	-	-
SZ:SWAZILAND	51,681.27	5,646.02	11,307.18	3,081.95	7,672.53	158.78
TG:TOGO	250.95	15	37,806.54	28	22,985.42	61.76

Table 6.4: (Cont'd)

Country	Year					
	2011		2012		2013	
	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value (in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)
TN:TUNISIA	5,213.79	1,406.83	2,756.57	782.7	3,860.00	733.49
UG:UGANDA	-	-	-	-	2.66	0.2
ZA:REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA	1,309,074.77	13,727.67	217,185.23	2,799.73	120,272.32	2,551.74
ZM:ZAMBIA	-	-	30.4	0	-	-
ZW:ZIMBABWE	-	-	-	-	270.26	3.52

Source: NRA Customs & Statistics Sierra Leone

Table 6.5: Import Value (Million Leones) by country of Origin: North America

Country	Year					
	2011		2012		2013	
	Value(in Million Leones)	Netmass (M.tons)	Value(in Million Leones)	Netmass(M.tons)	Value(in Million Leones)	Netmass(M.tons)
BARBADOS	137.56	5.30	-	-	-	-
CANADA	170,608.74	3,530.64	71,652.67	1,786.24	24,217.26	1,517.63
COSTA RICA	-	-	-	-	175.87	0.20
HONDURAS	133.14	24.49	-	-	-	-
JAMAICA	404.73	31.26	23.70	0.08	-	-
MEXICO	103.60	24.01	-	-	-	-
PA:PANAMA	584.88	24.86	-	-	1,397.46	161.53
UNITED STATES	508,902.64	38,633.55	243,803.73	6,489.97	287,382.46	6,876.47

Source: NRA Customs & Statistics Sierra Leone

7.0 Appendix

7.1 Technical Note

7.1.1 Data source

From the view point of SSL, 90 percent of data is primarily obtained from customs documents (declarations): forms filled by exporters and importers and submitted to Customs. In principle, a customs declaration identifies:

- the duties paid,
- the country of origin or destination,
- the port of entry or exit,
- the mode of transportation,
- the cost of insurance and freight and cost of transport.

A total of fifteen (15) fields covering: Country, Product, Régime / Procedure & Quantity codes; Net weight, Customs value, Taxation, Office, Transport type, Date, Trade flow, Trade type, Customs office, Form Number and Item Number are captured currently by Statistics Sierra Leone.

A. Coverage, Trade system and Valuation

The figures reported in this Bulletin represent trade data on the General System of trade as defined in the International Merchandise Trade Statistics Compilers Manual: Concepts and Definitions (IMTS, Rev.2).

- **Trade System:** two types (Special and General) and for SL, compilation is based on the **General System of trade**. Under the general trade system, imports include **all goods** entering the economic territory of the compiling country and exports include **all goods** leaving the economic territory of a compiling country.
- **Valuation:** Imported **goods are valued at c.i.f.-type** (that is including transportation and insurance costs up to the border of the compiling country) include all goods brought into the Customs territory for home use.
- Exports is **valued at f.o.b.- type** (that is excluding transport and insurance costs beyond the border of compiling country) are combination of domestic exports and re-exports

- Domestic exports include commodities grown in the country (coffee, cocoa, piassava and tobacco), extracted from its natural resources (Diamonds, Bauxite, Rutile, Gold and Ilmenite and Fish and Shrimps) or manufactured in the country (others). These include goods of foreign origin which have been assembled or transformed in the country.
- Re-exports are exports of goods of foreign origin which have not been materially transformed while in Sierra Leone.
- The general trade system provides a more comprehensive recording of the imports and exports flows than the special trade system. It also provides a better approximation of the **change of ownership** criterion required by Balance of payment and SNA 93.
- To promote the comparability of international merchandise trade statistics and taking into account the commercial and data reporting practices of the majority of countries and analytical needs, it is **recommended that**:
 - a) *The statistical value of exported goods be an FOB-type value;*
 - b) *The statistical value of imported goods be a CIF-type value; however, countries are encouraged to compile FOB-type value of imported goods as a supplementary information;*
- **It is further recommended that countries which compile only CIF-type values of imports** make efforts to collect separately data for freight and insurance, at the most detailed commodity/partner level possible.
- It is recognized that compilation of imports on the FOB-type basis and/or separate data for freight and insurance might entail a significant additional burden on respondents and merchandise trade compilers and should be undertaken based on the national situation and needs.
- However, countries are encouraged to explore additional methods which can facilitate the compilation of FOB-type values of imports and to provide a basis for a more systematic use of those values in future

B. All items on bills of entries are taken into consideration with the following exception:-

I. Imports

- Transshipment
- Re-warehousing
- Returned goods, postage stamps, bank notes and coins
- Empty containers
- Personal effects
- Goods imported by duty free shops
- Fish and other sea products landed in Mauritius from High Seas by Mauritian Vessels
- Goods returning after repairs abroad

II. Exports

- Returned goods
- Postage stamps, bank notes and coins
- Empty containers
- Goods sent for repairs abroad
- Personal effects
- Local sales and transfers

The Customs procedure Code (CPC) which indicates the status of a commodity with respect to the Customs and fiscal regulations help also to determine whether the transaction is to be included or not. Customized list of CPCs allow the production of tables by the General and Special Trade for the compilation of trade Statistics and National Accounts Statistics respectively. All goods in transit are recorded in Special Customs Procedure Code (CPC) and excluded.

C. Commodity Classification

- **Commodity Classification is based on:** The HS System at the eight digits level, SITC System, BEC System, and CPC System.

I. The HS System at the eight digits level:

HS07 contains 5,052 subheadings and 1,221 headings, grouped into 97 chapters and 21 sections. As a general rule, goods are arranged in order of their degree of

manufacture: raw materials, unworked products, semi-finished products and finished products. For example, live animals fall under Chapter 1, animal hides and skins under Chapter 41 and leather footwear under Chapter 64. The same order also exists within the chapters and headings.

The general structure of HS is as follows:

- Sections I to IV: Agricultural products
- Sections V to VII: Minerals, chemical and related products, plastics, rubber and articles thereof
- Sections VIII to X: Animal products, such as hides, skins and furskins, as well as wood, cork, pulp, paper, and articles thereof
- Sections XI and XII: Textiles, footwear and headgear
- Sections XIII to XV: Articles of stone, plaster, cement, asbestos, mica and the like, ceramic products, glass, pearls, precious or semi-precious stones, precious metals, jewellery, base metals and articles thereof
- Section XVI: Machinery, mechanical appliances and electrical equipment
- Section XVII: Vehicles, aircraft, vessels and associated transport equipment
- Section XVIII: Optical, photographic, cinematographic, measuring, checking, precision, medical or surgical instruments and apparatus, clocks and watches, musical instruments
- Section XIX: Arms and ammunition
- Sections XX and XXI: Miscellaneous manufactured articles, such as furniture, lighting fittings, prefabricated buildings, sports requisites, works of art, collectors' pieces and antiques
- **It is recommended that countries use HS for the collection, compilation and dissemination** of international merchandise trade statistics. Countries are encouraged to use the most current version of the HS.

II. SITC System:

It contains 3,993 basic headings and subheadings, which are assembled in 262 groups, 67 divisions and 10 sections. The sections are listed as follows:

- 0 Food and live animals
- 1 Beverages and tobacco
- 2 Crude materials, inedible, except fuels
- 3 Mineral fuels, lubricants and related materials
- 4 Animal and vegetable oils, fats and waxes
- 5 Chemicals and related products, not elsewhere specified
- 6 Manufactured goods classified chiefly by material
- 7 Machinery and transport equipment
- 8 Miscellaneous manufactured articles
- 9 Commodities and transactions not classified elsewhere in SITC

It is recommended that, in addition to HS, countries disseminate trade statistics also on SITC basis as needed to meet the user requirements.